

Indian film star Vikram in town for movie shoot

KUALA LUMPUR: Award-winning Indian film star Vikram (*pic*) is in town for the shooting of his new movie, *Iru Mugan*, a science-fiction thriller.

The actor, who has won numerous Filmfare Awards as well as National Film Awards in India, was spotted in Brickfields yesterday.

Many fans gathered around him for a chat or a glimpse and several passers-by were drawn to the large crowd.

Security personnel were strict and did not allow any photos or selfies with the star.

Vikram, sporting a full beard, said he arrived on Monday and would be here for a week and a half.

"*Iru Mugan* is directed by Anand Shankar," he said, declining to give details on the film.



The crew and actors had been filming in Brickfields since 6am and wrapped up around 3.30pm.

The entourage, comprising about 40 artistes and technical crew, then moved to Pudu, the next shooting location.

Local line producer from D'Cinema Sdn Bhd R. Siva said filming would mostly be in the Klang Valley and Malacca.

He said that so far, scenes had also been shot at KL International Airport and at the Twin Towers.

There were 20 local crew members helping out, said Siva, who oversaw pre-production and production activities.

South Indian actress Nayantara, who is playing the lead female role, will arrive in the next few days.



Free man: Cheh seen with his lawyer Rajpal Singh after he was acquitted.

Man accused of killing lover freed

Evidence not strong enough for conviction, rules judge

By M. MAGESWARI
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KUALA LUMPUR: A chicken rice seller accused of killing his girlfriend by setting her on fire was acquitted on a charge of causing her death. It was a verdict that left even the accused Cheh Chun Nam, a former bouncer at a club in Jalan Pudu here, in shock.

His sister, seated in the public gallery, openly broke down and rushed to Cheh, 37, who was handcuffed, and touched his shoulder.

She also repeatedly thanked his lead counsel Datuk Rajpal Singh, with tears in her eyes.

The sister also screamed at photographers to stay away and shielded Cheh's face with her handbag.

Shortly after, Rajpal spoke to both siblings and Cheh smiled and allowed himself to be photographed but would not talk about the acquittal.

Yesterday, High Court judge Justice Kamardin Hashim ruled that the totality of evidence did not lead to the possibility of Cheh causing his girlfriend's death.

"I agree that there is a possibility that the accused entered the place to

put out the fire and splash water on her. I cannot reject (the possibility) that the deceased could also have burned herself.

"It has to be strong and lead to one inference to the offence of the accused. The trial judge has to determine if the defence could raise reasonable doubt over the manslaughter charge under Section 304A of the Penal Code," said Justice Kamardin.

He added that he was satisfied that it was not safe to convict Cheh for manslaughter and freed him.

Cheh had claimed trial to causing the death of his girlfriend Chan Yee Mun, 23, by splashing toluene on her body and setting her on fire at his house in Taman Segar in Cheras between 2am and 3.30am on June 22, 2012.

In June last year, Justice Kamardin amended Cheh's original charge from murder to manslaughter after ruling that there was insufficient evidence to show that the accused had intention to kill his girlfriend.

The judge heard evidence from 22 prosecution witnesses during the trial.

Cheh, who was then separated

from his wife and has three daughters, gave his sworn evidence after the judge reduced his charge.

According to Cheh's evidence, he had stayed with his girlfriend for over a year before the incident.

Rajpal told the court yesterday that the couple loved each other and had fought over minor matters as Chan, a GRO in a club, was hot-tempered.

He said Cheh had gone out for dinner with Chan and her sibling on June 21, 2012. Upon returning home, Cheh heard Chan in a telephone conversation with a male and had asked about the caller, leading to a fight.

Cheh later went out to a restaurant to meet a friend. When he returned home at midnight, Cheh claimed to have told Chan that if she did not change her behaviour, he would leave her.

According to Cheh, Chan threatened to kill herself. Cheh claimed to be using the toilet when he heard Chan screaming. He rushed out and saw her on fire. He tried to put out the fire.

According to the DPP Mohd Nordin Ismail, Chan suffered 90% to 94% burn injuries on her body.

Three charged with murder win appeal

By MAIZATUL NAZLINA
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PUTRAJAYA: Three men charged with murdering a chairman of a Hindu organisation in Ipoh seven years ago escaped the gallows after the Federal Court granted their appeal.

Court of Appeal president Tan Sri Md Raus Sharif, who chaired the five-judge Federal Court panel, ruled that the conviction against A. Manimaran, 27, S. Saravanan, 32, and K. Perumal, 34, was not safe.

Salesman Manimaran, trader Saravanan and security guard Perumal were sentenced to death by the Ipoh High Court on July 16, 2013 for murdering N. Sindambaram, 64, chairman of the Ipoh Hindu Devasthanam Paripalana Sabah, which manages the Sri Maha Mariamman temple in Jalan Sungai Pari and the Sri Subramaniam Temple in Gunung Cheroh.

They were accused of committing the offence between 11.30pm on Jan 11, 2009 and 2.10am the next day at 759, Jalan Wayang in Buntong, Perak.

Justice Md Raus Sharif said the Federal Court agreed with the earlier decision by the High Court that a prima facie case had not been established.

"Thus, we allow the appeal. Conviction and sentence are set aside," he said in acquitting the trio yesterday.

Other judges on the panel were Justices Ahmad Maarop, Hasan Lah, Abu Samah Nordin and Zaharah Ibrahim.

When the verdict was announced, Saravanan stomped his feet in joy while Manimaran shed tears. Perumal did not show any feeling.

Saravanan was represented by counsel Afifuddin Ahmad Hafifi, Perumal by T. Vijayandran while Hisyam Teh Poh Teik represented Manimaran.

Deputy public prosecutor K. Mangai led the prosecution.

On Nov 29, 2010, High Court Judicial Commissioner Teo Say Eng acquitted and discharged Manimaran, Saravanan and Perumal without calling for their defence, ruling that the prosecution had failed to

establish a prima facie case against them.

However, after an appeal by the prosecution, the Court of Appeal ordered the three to enter their defence in the Ipoh High Court.

Manimaran, Saravanan and Perumal were sentenced to death on July 15 after the court ruled that the prosecution had succeeded in establishing a prima facie case.

During the hearing, Sindambaram's widow T. Letchumy testified that she had gone to bed at 10.30pm on Jan 11, 2009 while her husband was in the hall watching television.

Letchumy, who was the eighth prosecution witness, said she was awakened by the noise of curtains being pulled and when she went to the hall, she saw her husband surrounded by six men wearing masks.

She said she saw a pool of blood on the floor near a coffee table where her husband was seated and when the men left, she ran to the neighbour's house for help.

She said she brought her husband to the hospital where he was pronounced dead at about 6.30am.

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